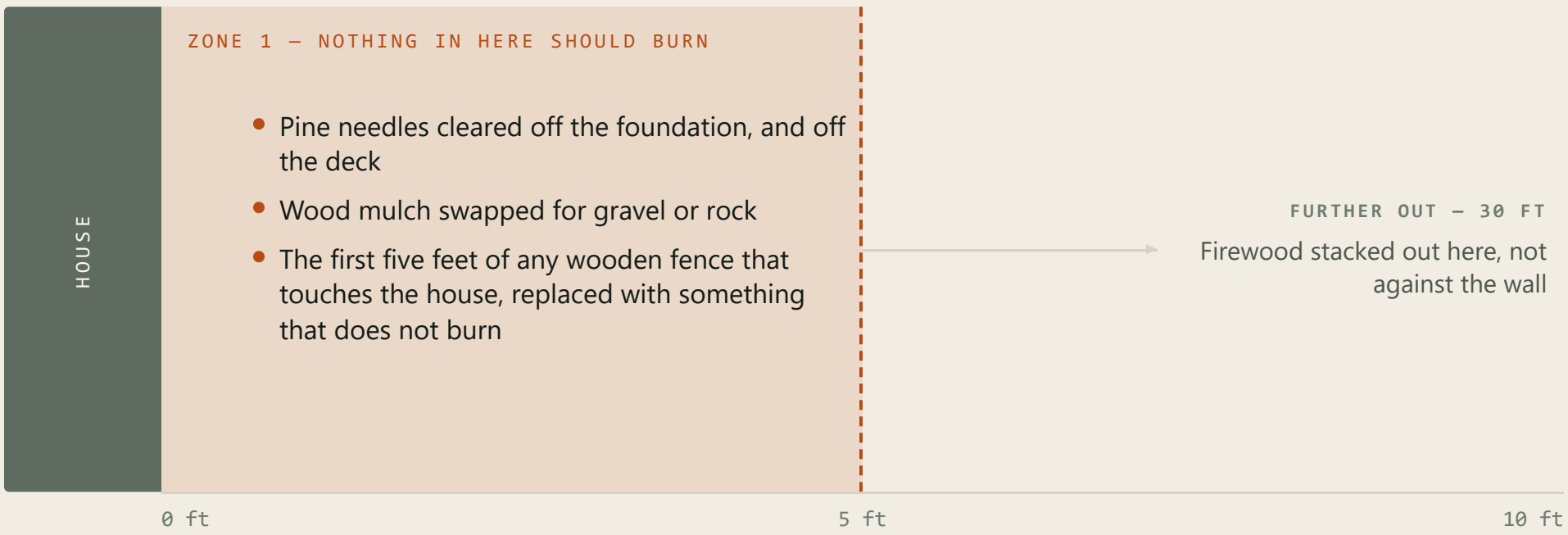
DEFENSIBLE SPACE · ZONE 1

The five feet that *decide it*.

Houses in a wildfire mostly do not catch from a wall of flame. Embers land against the base of the building, find something that burns, and the house does the rest.



78% of buildings with **a lot of vegetation within five feet** of the walls were destroyed — **nearly twice the rate** of buildings with little vegetation in that strip. Measured across more than **71,000 properties** inside wildfire perimeters, 2016–2019.

WHAT WE WOULD TELL YOU AT THE DOOR

None of this needs a contractor. It needs a Saturday and a wheelbarrow, and it is worth more than anything else you could spend the same day on. Come and find us when you get to the juniper line at twenty feet.

Sources: IBHS / Zesty.ai, “Nearly Doubling a Property’s Wildfire Survival Rate,” 8 April 2021 — figures read first-hand 14 September 2026. Zone 1 and the five-foot guidance: Colorado State Forest Service, *Home Ignition Zone*.
Colorado numbers this ground Zone 1. “Zone 0” is California’s term for it.

Sixfold
MONUMENT, CO